
User Manual

for

Central Mess Management System(CMMS)

Version <1.0>

Prepared by

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1. Introduction

The Centralized Mess Management System (CMMS) is a web-based application designed to digitize and streamline all mess-related operations in a university hostel environment. It provides a self-service portal for students to view daily menus, book extra meals, apply for mess leave rebates, submit feedback, and view their monthly billing — all from a single interface.

Administrators have a dedicated dashboard to manage menus, process rebates, handle feedback, oversee billing, manage extra item inventory, and scan QR codes for order verification.

2. System Requirements

- Browser: Google Chrome (v90+), Mozilla Firefox (v88+), Microsoft Edge (v90+), or Safari (v14+).
- Internet: A stable internet connection is required.
- Device: Desktop, laptop, tablet, or smartphone.
- Recommended Resolution: 1280x800 or higher for the best experience.

3. Getting Started

3.1 Accessing the System

Open your web browser and navigate to the CMMS application URL provided by your institution (e.g., <https://cmms.youruniversity.ac.in>).

3.2 Home Page

The Home Page is the first screen you will see. It displays two login options:

- Student Login — For students to access menus, book extras, apply for rebates, view billing, and submit feedback.
- Admin Login — For mess administrators to manage operations, review analytics, and handle system administration.

Click the appropriate card to proceed to the login screen.

3.3 Student Registration (Signup)

If you are a new student user, you can create an account:

1. On the Login page, click "Don't have an account? Sign up".
2. Fill in the following required fields: Full Name, Roll Number, Email Address (must be unique; institutional email recommended), Hall of Residence (select from dropdown), and Password (minimum 8 characters).
3. Click "Sign Up".
4. Upon successful registration, you will be redirected to the login page. Log in with your new credentials.

Note: Each email address can only be registered once. If you encounter a "duplicate email" error, use the Forgot Password option to recover your account.

3.4 Login

5. On the Home Page, click "Student Login" or "Admin Login".
6. Enter your registered Email and Password.
7. Click "Log In".
8. Upon successful login, you will be redirected to your respective dashboard.

Note: Your session is maintained using secure cookies. You will remain logged in until you explicitly log out or the session expires.

3.5 Forgot Password

9. On the Login page, click "Forgot your password?".
10. Enter your registered Email Address.
11. Click "Send Reset Link".
12. Check your email inbox for a password reset link from CMMS.
13. Click the link in the email. You will be redirected to a password reset form.
14. Enter your New Password (minimum 8 characters) and Confirm Password.
15. Click "Reset Password".
16. Upon success, you will be redirected to the login page. Log in with your new password.

Note: The reset link is valid for a single use and expires after a limited time. If it expires, request a new link.

4. Student Portal

4.1 Student Dashboard

After logging in, you are taken to the Student Dashboard — your central hub with quick-access cards to all features:

Card	Description
Daily Menu	View the weekly mess menu for your hall
Extra Meals	Browse and book extra meal items
Rebates	Apply for mess leave rebates
My Bookings	View your order history and QR codes
Feedbacks	Submit feedback or complaints
Billing	View your monthly mess bill and download PDF

The Navigation Bar at the top includes quick links to Daily Menu, Extra Meals, and Leaves & Rebates, plus a Notification Bell showing unseen notification count, and your Profile menu.

4.2 Daily Mess Menu

Navigate to the Daily Menu page via the dashboard card or the top navigation link.

- Hall Selector: Use the Hostel dropdown to select your hall (defaults to your assigned hall).
- Single Day View: View the menu for one day. Use left/right arrows or the day dropdown to switch between days.
- Weekly View: Click the Weekly View toggle to see the entire week at a glance in a scrollable layout.

Each day's menu is organized into four meal cards: Breakfast, Lunch, Snacks, and Dinner. Each card lists dishes with their category (Veg / Non-Veg / Special).

4.3 Extra Meals (Extras)

Items are displayed as cards showing name, price, and available quantity. Only in-stock items (count > 0) are shown, filtered by your hall.

Adding to Cart:

17. Click "Add to Cart" or "+" on an item card.
18. The item is added to your cart with quantity 1.
19. Click again to increase quantity (up to the available stock limit).
20. A message will appear if you have reached the maximum available quantity.

4.4 Cart & Checkout

Cart Management:

- View all items with name, quantity, unit price, and subtotal.
- Use "+" and "-" buttons to adjust quantities.
- Click the delete/remove button to remove an item entirely.
- The cart automatically validates quantities against real-time inventory.

Checkout:

21. Review your cart items and total amount.
22. Click "Checkout" / "Place Order".
23. The system validates all items against current inventory, deducts quantities from stock, creates confirmed booking records, and generates a unique QR Code (format: QR-XXXXXXXXXXXX) for your entire order.
24. Upon success, your cart is cleared and the QR code is viewable in My Bookings.

Note: *If any item becomes out of stock during checkout, the transaction will be cancelled and you will be notified. No partial checkouts occur.*

4.5 My Bookings

View your complete order history, grouped by QR code. Each order group shows:

- QR Code ID (e.g., QR-XXXXXXXXXXXX)
- Items ordered with names, quantities, and prices
- Total Cost of the order
- Booking Date & Time
- Status: Not Scanned (awaiting collection) or Scanned (collected)

4.6 Rebate Application

Navigate to the Rebate page from the dashboard or the Leaves & Rebates navigation link.

Eligibility Rules:

- Minimum leave duration: 3 consecutive days
- Applications must be submitted at least 2 days before the leave start date
- Rebate rate varies by month
- Maximum 30 days of leave per semester

Submitting an Application:

25. Select your Leave Start Date and Leave End Date using the date pickers.
26. Enter your Leave Location (where you will be during the leave period).
27. Click "Submit Rebate Application".
28. Upon success, you will see a confirmation and the application will appear in your history.

Note: *You cannot apply for overlapping leave periods. Check your existing applications before submitting a new one.*

Viewing Application History:

Below the form, all your rebate applications are listed with status: Pending, Approved, or Rejected.

4.7 Feedback & Complaints

29. Navigate to the Feedbacks page from the dashboard card.
30. Select a Category: Food Quality, Hygiene, Service, Staff Behavior, or Other.
31. Enter your Feedback Message in the text area.
32. Click "Submit Feedback".
33. Your submission will appear in your feedback history with a Pending status.

You will receive a notification when the admin updates the status to In Progress or Resolved.

4.8 Billing

Navigate to the Billing page from the dashboard card.

- Select a Month from the dropdown to view your bill for that month.
- The bill shows: Fixed Monthly Charges, Extra Meals Cost, Rebate Deduction, Grand Total, and Payment Status.
- Click "Download Bill PDF" to download a formatted copy of your bill.

4.9 Notifications

Click the Notification Bell in the navigation bar to view your notifications. Notifications are sent for: rebate status updates, feedback status updates, billing status changes, order collection confirmations, and payment reminders.

4.10 Logout

34. Click your profile avatar/name in the navigation bar.
35. Select "Logout".
36. Your authentication cookies are cleared and you are redirected to the Home Page.

5. Admin Portal

5.1 Admin Dashboard

After logging in as an admin, you are taken to the Admin Dashboard with card-based navigation to all administrative functions:

Card	Description
Billing Management	View and manage student mess bills and payments
Extras Management	Manage extra meal items, pricing, and availability
Feedback	Review and respond to student feedback and complaints
Rebate Management	Process and manage student rebate applications
Send Notification	Send targeted or broadcast notifications to students
Menu Management	Update daily mess menus and meal schedules
QR-Scanner	Scan QR codes to verify student order collections

5.2 Menu Management

Manage the weekly mess menu for all halls.

Adding a Menu Item:

37. Navigate to Menu Management from the admin dashboard.
38. Select the Hall, Day (Monday–Sunday), and Meal Type (Breakfast / Lunch / Snacks / Dinner).
39. Enter the Dish Name and optional Category (Veg / Non-Veg / Special).
40. Click "Add Item" / "Save".

Editing / Deleting a Menu Item:

- Edit: Locate the item in the menu grid and click Edit to modify the dish name or category, then click Update.
- Delete: Click Delete and confirm the deletion when prompted to remove an item.

5.3 Extras Management

Items are grouped by hall showing stock and sold counts. A Live Order Feed displays the 50 most recent confirmed bookings across all halls.

Adding / Editing / Deleting an Extra Item:

- Add: Select the target Hall, enter Item Name, Price, and Stock Quantity, then click Add Item.
- Edit: Locate the item, click Edit, update the fields, and click Save.

- Delete: Locate the item, click Delete, and confirm.

Note: *Deleting an item cascades to its associated booking slots.*

5.4 Rebate Management

All rebate applications are listed with student details, leave period, duration, location, and current status.

Approving / Rejecting a Rebate:

41. Locate the application.
42. Click "Approve" or "Reject".
43. Optionally add an Admin Note that will be included in the student's notification.
44. Click "Submit".
45. The student is automatically notified of the status change.

Note: *Approved rebates are automatically factored into the student's monthly bill calculation as a deduction.*

5.5 Feedback Management

All student feedbacks are listed with category, content, date, student name, and current status.

Updating Feedback Status:

46. Locate the feedback entry.
47. Change the status to Pending, In Progress, or Resolved.
48. Click "Update".
49. The student is automatically notified of the status change.

5.6 Billing Management

Viewing Bills:

Select a Month from the dropdown to view a table of all students' billing data: name, email, roll number, hall, fixed charges, extras cost, rebate deduction, grand total, and payment status.

Updating Payment Status:

50. Locate the student row.
51. Change the payment status: Paid (records payment date automatically), Unpaid (default), Overdue, or Waived.
52. Optionally add an Admin Note.
53. Click "Update".
54. The student receives a contextual notification about the status change.

Sending Payment Reminders:

55. Locate the student and click Send Reminder.
56. Optionally enter a Custom Message.
57. Click "Send". The student receives a reminder notification.

5.7 Send Notifications

Send custom notifications to students using these targeting options:

Method	Description
Broadcast	Send to all students
By User ID	Target specific student(s) by user ID
By Email	Target student(s) by email address (comma-separated)
By Roll Number	Target student(s) by roll number (comma-separated)

58. Select the targeting method.
59. Enter / select the recipient(s).
60. Enter the Title and Content of the notification.
61. Click "Send Notification".

***Tip:** Use the student list lookup to find specific student details before sending targeted notifications.*

5.8 QR Code Scanner

Verify student order collections using QR codes.

Scanning a QR Code:

62. Navigate to the QR Scanner page from the admin dashboard.
63. Allow camera access when prompted.
64. Point the camera at the student's QR code.
65. The system looks up the QR code, displays the student's name, ordered items, and total cost, marks all associated bookings as collected (confirmed-scanned), and sends a confirmation notification to the student.

QR Code Statuses:

- Valid (Not Scanned) — First scan: order is verified and marked as collected.
- Already Scanned — QR code has already been processed; details shown but no changes made.
- Invalid — QR code not found in the system; error message displayed.

6. Troubleshooting & FAQs

Q: I forgot my password. How do I reset it?

Click "Forgot your password?" on the Login page, enter your email, and follow the instructions in the reset email sent to you.

Q: I can't see any menu items for my hall.

Ensure your hall of residence is correctly assigned in your profile. If no menu has been uploaded for your hall yet, contact the mess administrator.

Q: My cart checkout failed with an error.

This usually means one or more items went out of stock while you were shopping. Review your cart, remove unavailable items, and try again.

Q: I submitted a rebate application but it still shows 'Pending'.

Rebate applications require admin approval. You will receive a notification once the admin processes your application.

Q: My bill shows an incorrect amount.

Verify that your approved rebate days and extra meal bookings are correct. If there is a discrepancy, contact the mess administrator through the Feedback page.

Q: I'm an admin but I can't access admin pages.

Ensure your account has the admin role assigned. Regular student accounts cannot access admin pages. Contact the system administrator to update your role.

Q: How do I collect my extra meal order?

After checkout, a QR code is generated and visible in your My Bookings page. Show this QR code to the mess counter staff, who will scan it using the admin QR Scanner to confirm your collection.

Q: I didn't receive a password reset email.

Check your spam/junk folder. If the email still doesn't arrive, contact your institution's IT support. In development environments, the reset link may be printed to the server console instead.